

Application for Security Placement

Dear Symphony Recruitment Team,

I am applying for the Security Placement at Symphony because it combines the analytical and technical work I already do with the secure communications and critical infrastructure protection I want to build. The opportunity to support security operations, risk management and compliance initiatives while gaining hands-on experience in modern information security practices is exactly the environment I need to grow. I am available to start the 9-month placement and comfortable with the Belfast location.

My background combines practical IT support and security work with formal analytical training. I am an MSc Information Security graduate from Royal Holloway, awarded with Merit, with CompTIA Security+ and ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity, preceded by a BCA in computer applications. That means I understand not only how to resolve technical problems but how to approach complex challenges in a structured way, which is central to a role that requires analytical skills, attention to detail and a high standard of personal integrity.

In my current IT support position I am the first point of contact for 15 colleagues across 15 to 20 devices, troubleshooting access and system problems, monitoring server health and maintaining network and website-access controls. I handle four to five access requests a day through on-premises Active Directory and investigate four to five suspicious emails a day, recording findings and alerting colleagues to recurring tactics. I also built a local tool that maps Windows error codes to their common causes and used it to trace intermittent server freezes to missing or corrupted DLLs. My technical skills include Python, PowerShell and SQL, which I use for task automation and security scripting.

Two things I want to be straightforward about. I have not worked in a SOC or secure communications environment, so that specific experience is something I would expect to develop through Symphony's placement rather than claim as existing. What I do bring is a genuine analytical mindset and attention to detail. At Co-op, as Person in Charge, I conduct weekly risk assessments and daily compliance checks, maintain the assessment records, and coordinate seven or eight colleagues per shift while explaining requirements to people who have no particular interest in them.

What draws me to Symphony specifically is the focus on protecting critical infrastructure and enabling secure communications for over 1,400 global institutions. The opportunity to contribute to that work through a structured placement with real responsibility, mentorship from experienced developers and exposure to modern security operations is exactly the kind of challenge I am looking for. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my skills and experience could contribute to your team.

Kind regards,

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